endpoint filter pipeline. Like the middleware pipeline in ASP.NET Core, the MVC filter pipeline consists of a series of components connected as a pipe, so the output of one filter feeds into the input of the next. In section 21.3 we'll look at the similarities and differences between these two pipelines, and when you should choose one over the other.

In section 21.4 you'll see how to create a simple custom filter. Rather than focus on the functionality of the filter itself, you'll learn how to apply it to multiple endpoints in section 21.5. In section 21.6 you'll see how the choice of *where* you apply your attributes affects the order in which your filters execute.

The filter pipeline is a complex topic, but it can enable some advanced behaviors in your app and potentially reduce overall complexity. In this chapter you'll learn the basics of the pipeline and how it works. In chapter 22 we dig into practical examples of filters, looking at the filters that come out of the box in ASP.NET Core, as well as building custom filters to extract common code from your controllers and Razor Pages.

Before we can start writing code, we should get to grips with the basics of the filter pipeline. The first section of this chapter explains what the pipeline is, why you might want to use it, and how it differs from the middleware pipeline.

21.1 Understanding the MVC filter pipeline

In this section you'll learn all about the MVC filter pipeline. You'll see where it fits in the life cycle of a typical request and the roles of the six types of filters available.